



To support these growth ambitions over the next 25 years, India must also upskill its vast young population. From overhauling the education system to creating centres of excellence, especially in higher education and research, we must build an ecosystem of the future, so that our young people have access to affordable world-class schools and universities in India itself. This, to me, is the single biggest intervention required to move up the value chain and its impact will be felt till the bottom of the pyramid and make the growth more inclusive.

India is also extremely vulnerable to the impact of climate change. This can be a big challenge to our growth aspirations, given our massive population—from food and water security to livelihood issues.

We must integrate ‘sustainability’ into everything we do and make it a national movement. Businesses will have to be climate resilient. Sadly, the awareness is too low right now and we need a concerted effort to preserve our natural environment and rich biodiversity. Public-private-partnerships can play an extremely important role in this area and throw up innovative solutions to manage the balance between growth and sustainability. India’s success will be the world’s success in this particular area.

Last but not the least, while the fruits of our economic growth will help uplift hundreds of millions more Indians from the low-income bracket, we must double down on building an inclusive economy through philanthropy. Here, individual philanthropy and NGOs are mov-

ing the needle but it’s still too little for a large nation like India. We must create a more evolved culture of giving back some of the fruits of growth for those left behind, by opening windows of opportunity. Here, our large young population can be a big change agent and we will have many more privileged ones amongst them in the decades to come.

A supercharged India@100 is not just an aspiration; it’s something very much within our grasp. All it requires is the collective will of all stakeholders to make sure this rocket takes off and reaches the orbit. I am pretty sure we will get there and perhaps even exceed our expectations. Looking forward to our tryst with destiny once more. **BT**

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